

bills went unpaid. Bob eventually found another job making about \$18,000 a year, with a budget that required more than \$40,000 just to break even.

The baby was born with his parents separated and Sue living with her parents. Bob and Sue had lost their home and their new car and still owed nearly \$16,000—all in less than three years of marriage.

We'll pick up the story of Bob and Sue a little later as we deal with the issue of, "What do we do now?"

Maybe you're thinking, "Well, that won't happen to me," or "It's already too late for us." Neither is true. God's Word has both the prevention and the cure. If you haven't made the errors yet, you have a head start. But even if you have, God's Word offers the absolute cure.

Jesus dedicated about two thirds of all parables in the New Testament to telling us the principles of how to handle money properly. When was the last time you had somebody take the time to teach you how to handle money properly? If you did, you're among the fortunate few.

What I would like to do is spend some time discussing practical principles of finances. First, we'll look at the biblical basis for *why* we are to handle money properly. Then we'll look at the practical applications in everyday life, like balancing check-books, buying life insurance, selecting the right house, or buying the car you "need." Hopefully, by the time you finish this book, you'll have the necessary tools to handle your finances properly.

How important is money? About 80 percent of our waking day is consumed in thinking about money: making it, saving it, spending it, or giving it away. If this area isn't managed properly, everything else is out of balance. "He who is faithful in a very little thing is faithful also in much; and he who is unrighteous in a very little thing is unrighteous also in much" (Luke 16:10).